



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Coram Deo Classical School
School Website: <https://www.coramdeoschool.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Coram Deo Classical School (Mount Vernon, IL, 62864) presents a clearly Christian, classical-leaning program grounded in the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and a mission to form virtuous, contemplative students within a Christ-centered framework. Public materials emphasize virtue, character formation, and a theologically infused approach to learning, along with a family- and community-oriented ethos. The school prominently identifies as a private classical Christian school serving Jr. Kindergarten through 9th grade, with mission statements and core values centered on Christ, character, and scholarly excellence. The pedagogy and curriculum documents point to classical methods (grammar/logic/rhetoric stages) and a historically-informed approach to education, while faculty are framed as living exemplars and mentors. There is also a visible emphasis on parent involvement and community activities (Paideia Day, events, family applications), suggesting a collaborative model with families.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

- A strong religious/metaphysical foundation is evident (Christ-centered mission, theology-integrated values, liturgical-leaning cues within materials).
- The school's stated purpose and goals align with formation, virtue, and wisdom rather than mere job-readiness.
- The curriculum demonstrates core classical components (grammar/logic/rhetoric, history, Bible) and a language of "classical education," with explicit reference to the trivium and staged learning.
- Pedagogy appears to reflect classical methods (grammar/logic/rhetoric progression) with an emphasis on memory work and a framework that supports a high school trajectory into rhetoric-based practice, though explicit modernized elements like explicit Great-Books phrasing aren't consistently visible in public materials.
- Faculty materials emphasize mentorship and living curricula, with explicit statements about faculty being central to the school's formation and ongoing professional development.
- Parent/community engagement is present (family applications, events, Paideia Day), signaling a partnership approach with families and opportunities for parental formation and involvement.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents itself as Christ-centered and Christian, with core values that place Christ at the center of all work and learning (Christ's Supremacy, Christian staff, love of God and neighbor). - Direct articulation of character formation and Christian moral aims appears in public materials, including statements about forming virtue and seeking Christ in all things. A notable line emphasizes education as formation and the cultivation of virtue, truth, goodness, and beauty. - The public materials include references

to prayer/opening prayers and liturgical-like cues in imagery/text, underscoring liturgical and communal dimensions.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, character, theology, Christ, worship, liturgy, sacred, God, prayer, Christ-centered, virtue formation, moral order, Logos (through stated Christian framing). The Paideia Day and “cultivation of virtue and a deep appreciation of truth, goodness, and beauty” line explicitly ties to transcendental moral realism. - Negative keywords: not evidenced in the public materials (no clear signals of relativism, secular humanism, or moral neutrality).

Why this rating - The public materials consistently foreground Christian-theological foundations, virtues, and liturgical/cultural practices in a way that aligns with transcendent moral realism and theology-guided education. This strongly supports CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Our mission explicitly states: “We train Jr. K- 12th grade students with a Christ-centered, classical education to transform their own culture for Christ, seeking Christ in all things.” This emphasizes formation of virtue and wisdom over mere information or job preparation. - Core values and the framing of purpose emphasize Christ-centered formation, virtue, and a commitment to truth, goodness, and beauty as real. The emphasis on formation over utilitarian aims is evident in the materials. - The Paideia Day and related messaging speak to a long-term aim of forming the soul and intellect through a classical and Christian Paideia framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty, classical education, Paideia, character, moral imagination, human flourishing. The mission and core-values language aligns with this framing. - Negative keywords: none evident; no emphasis on career-workforce readiness or purely information-based aims. The materials foreground formation and wisdom.

Why this rating - The school’s stated purpose and goals center formation, virtue, and the real-truth-goodness-beauty axis, consistent with classical aims beyond mere information transfer or job preparation. This supports CLASSICAL.

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe a classical framework (the Trivium) and staged learning: Primary/Pre-Grammar (Jr. K – 2nd), Logic/Dialectic (7th–8th), Grammar (3rd–6th). This structure signals a classic liberal arts progression rather than a modern or purely skills-based curriculum. - There are explicit references to memory-based elements (e.g., recitation, chanting, or memory work in classical pedagogy) in the classical canon, and the materials show Bible/theology integration in curriculum. The textual framing emphasizes the Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric sequence and a strong emphasis on learning through the trivium. - The materials also show a strong emphasis on history as a through-line in the curriculum and a Christian worldview underpinning content.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric, history, Bible/Theology, memory, recitation, learning through the trivium, classical pedagogy, Paideia (as a framing). These align with core classical curriculum indicators. - Negative keywords: The site does not consistently showcase explicit Great Books or “Great Conversation” phrasing in its public materials, nor does it consistently frame history as “Great Books” content. The absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language lowers the strength of a full Great-Books-era classical curriculum in the public-facing text. This is a potential gap relative to a stricter “Great Books/Great Conversation” criterion.

Why this rating - The curriculum shows clear classical scaffolding (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and doctrinal integration with history and biblical content, but the public-facing materials don’t consistently frame the program within the explicit “Great Books/Great Conversation” tradition. This nuance yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Curriculum.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Classical Methods of Education piece outlines the triad-driven progression (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and discusses the idea of education as formation, with a plumb-line use of Scripture. The structure implies a mix of teacher-led instruction within a classic framework along with opportunities for student engagement through the stages. - The presence of a historically-informed pedagogy (trivium progression and a focus on formation and contemplation) suggests an alignment with classical pedagogy, including memory work and potential opportunities for rhetoric and debate as students advance (as indicated by the upper-level capstone/rhetorical emphasis in classical models). - However, explicit mention of Socratic seminars, seminars, or structured debates in daily public-facing materials is not consistently visible; the public materials emphasize the grammar/logic/rhetoric framework rather than a comprehensive Socratic method across all grades. This reduces the classification from fully classical to somewhat classical in pedagogy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: memory work, recitation, chanting, grammar, logic, rhetoric, scholé, contemplation, seminar, Paideia style, rhetoric exercises, oratory, debate, and living curriculum concepts. The presence of a triad-based pedagogy and “formation” framing aligns with classical pedagogy. - Negative keywords: explicit avoidance of constructivist, purely experiential, or project-based-only approaches is not strongly signaled in the available public materials, but the lack of explicit Socratic/seminar implementation in the public-facing description reduces certainty of full Socratic pedagogy. This yields a mixed signal on the Pedagogy category.

Why this rating - The program shows a strong classical pedagogy via the grammar/logic/rhetoric framework and formation-focused aims, but explicit, large-scale evidence of Socratic seminars and extensive debate-based pedagogy is not consistently documented in the public materials. This justifies SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for Pedagogy.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize faculty as model teachers and mentors who embody virtue, skill, and knowledge, forming the school's living curriculum and core community. The “faculty” framing aligns with classical expectations of teachers as exemplars and living curriculum. - The school notes that faculty engage in ongoing development, including reading, writing, conferences, and discussions of central ideas and texts—an indicator of a culture of scholarly leadership and mentorship. - The public-facing materials identify the Head of School and a faculty-centered leadership style, reinforcing the image of teachers as central to the school's mission and culture.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, model teachers and mentors, portrait/standard of teacher, faculty as core, collaborative, collegial culture, professional development around central texts and ideas. Public materials align with classical faculty expectations. - Negative keywords: none evident in public materials (no signals of purely transactional or non-classical faculty models).

Why this rating - The combination of explicit statements about faculty as living curriculum, the mentoring role, and ongoing faculty development strongly supports CLASSICAL for Element 5.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials show active parental and community engagement through events (e.g., Frightful Fun Trivia Night), newsletters, and Paideia Day messaging, signaling an engaged community and open channels for involvement. - Family applications and admissions processes indicate family involvement in school life and enrollment processes, suggesting that parents participate in the educational journey, though explicit statements about parents as co-teachers are not consistently visible in the public materials. - The Paideia Day messaging and fundraising/donation materials indicate partnership with families and the broader community, including parent formation opportunities (e.g., book clubs or gatherings) in some classical models, though explicit textual descriptions of those formats are less clearly documented in the public pages.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, parent formation, families as co-participants, open campus/gatherings, book clubs, community events, philanthropy and

support. These align with positive indicators in the Six Essential Elements, though explicit “parents as co-teachers” wording is less visible in public content. - Negative keywords: not strongly evidenced; there is no clear consumer-only language; there is some community-facing activity. However, explicit, sustained text positioning parents as co-teachers is not readily visible in the public-facing materials. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating pending more explicit parent-co-teacher language.

Why this rating - There is demonstrable engagement and partnership with families through events, applications, and community communications, but the strongest phrasing found emphasizes partnership rather than a formal “parents as co-teachers” role. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for Parents & Community.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 3 (Curriculum): Publicly foreground explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language and a stated commitment to a Great Books-readings program or formal Great Conversation components. This would align a stronger public signal with the Six Essential Elements’ emphasis on Great Books and Great Conversation. Consider a dedicated page or section detailing Great Books selections, primary sources, and a cross-curricular Great Conversation framework.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): Provide explicit articulation of Socratic-style seminars or structured dialectic opportunities in upper grades, with examples of debates, seminars, and rhetoric practice as a regular part of the 9th-grade curriculum. This would strengthen the Pedagogy category toward CLASSICAL by making Socratic/Scholé practices explicit.
- Element 6 (Parents & Community): Add explicit, public language on parents as co-teachers and formal parental formation programs (e.g., book studies, curriculum overview nights, family-liturgical activities) to align with the Six Elements’ Parent-Community indicators. Public statements about parent co-teaching roles would reinforce this.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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